Learn more about LSEG

Anthropic's lawyers take blame for AI 'hallucination' in music publishers' lawsuit

By **Blake Brittain**

May 15, 2025 9:25 PM GMT+2 · Updated May 15, 2025



Anthropic logo is seen in this illustration taken May 20, 2024. REUTERS/Dado Ruvic/Illustration Purchase Licensing Rights

May 15 (Reuters) - An attorney defending artificial-intelligence company Anthropic in a copyright lawsuit over music lyrics told a California federal judge on Thursday that her law firm Latham & Watkins was responsible for an incorrect footnote in an expert report caused by an AI "hallucination."

Ivana Dukanovic said in a court filing that the expert had relied on a legitimate academic journal article, but Dukanovic created a citation for it using Anthropic's chatbot Claude, which made up a fake title and authors in what the attorney called "an embarrassing and unintentional mistake."

Jumpstart your morning with the latest legal news delivered straight to your inbox from The Daily Docket newsletter. Sign up here.

"Unfortunately, although providing the correct publication title, publication year, and link to the provided source, the returned citation included an inaccurate title and incorrect authors," Dukanovic said.

The lawsuit from music publishers Universal Music Group (UMG.AS) , Concord and ABKCO over Anthropic's alleged misuse of their lyrics to train Claude is one of several high-stakes disputes between copyright owners and tech companies over the use of their work to train AI systems.

The publishers' attorney Matt Oppenheim of Oppenheim + Zebrak told the court during a hearing on Tuesday that Anthropic data scientist Olivia Chen may have used an AI-fabricated source to bolster the company's argument in a dispute over evidence.

U.S. Magistrate Judge Susan van Keulen said at the hearing that the allegation raised "a very serious and grave issue," and that there was "a world of difference between a missed citation and a hallucination generated by AI."

Dukanovic responded on Thursday that Chen had cited a real article from the journal American Statistician that supported her argument, but the attorneys had missed that Claude introduced an incorrect title and authors.

A spokesperson for the plaintiffs declined to comment on the new filing. Dukanovic and a spokesperson for Anthropic did not immediately respond to requests for comment.

Several attorneys have been criticized or sanctioned by courts in recent months for mistakenly citing nonexistent cases and other incorrect information hallucinated by AI in their filings.

Dukanovic said in Thursday's court filing that Latham had implemented "multiple levels of additional review to work to ensure that this does not occur again."

The case is Concord Music Group Inc v. Anthropic PBC, U.S. District Court for the Northern District of California, No. 5:24-cv-03811.

For the music publishers: Matt Oppenheim of Oppenheim + Zebrak

For Anthropic: Sy Damle of Latham & Watkins

Read more:

Music publishers sue AI company Anthropic over song lyrics

Anthropic reaches deal on AI 'guardrails' in lawsuit over music lyrics

Anthropic expert accused of using AI-fabricated source in copyright case

Reporting by Blake Brittain in Washington

Our Standards: **The Thomson Reuters Trust Principles.**

Suggested Topics:

Legal Industry

Purchase Licensing Rights

Blake Brittain
Thomson Reuters

Blake Brittain reports on intellectual property law, including patents, trademarks, copyrights and trade secrets, for Reuters Legal. He has previously written for Bloomberg Law and Thomson Reuters Practical Law and practiced as an attorney.

Read Next / Editor's Picks

Legal Industry

US law firm leasing jumped 17% in first half, report says

August 28, 2026

Government

Judge in Google privacy class action awards lawyers $147 million in legal fees

August 28, 2026

Litigation

Energy company Enel taps former Giuliani, Bannon counsel to fight legal-fee lawsuit

August 26, 2026

Legal Industry

US law firm revenues soared in first half of 2026 - Wells Fargo survey

August 25, 2026

Latest

Home

Authors

Topic Sitemap

Archive

Article Sitemap

Media

Videos

Pictures

Graphics

Podcasts

Browse

World

Business

Markets

Sustainability

Legal

Breakingviews

Technology

Investigations

Sports

Science

Lifestyle

About Reuters

About Reuters

Media Center

Advertise with Us

Careers

Reuters News Agency

Brand Attribution Guidelines

Reuters and AI

Reuters Leadership

Reuters Fact Check

Reuters Diversity Report

Commercial Disclosure (Japan)

Stay Informed

Download the App (iOS)

Download the App (Android)

Newsletters

Subscribe

Information you can trust

Reuters, the news and media division of Thomson Reuters, is the world’s largest multimedia news provider, reaching billions of people worldwide every day. Reuters provides business, financial, national and international news to professionals via desktop terminals, the world's media organizations, industry events and directly to consumers.

Follow Us

LSEG Products

Workspace

Access unmatched financial data, news and content in a highly-customised workflow experience on desktop, web and mobile.

Data Catalogue

Browse an unrivalled portfolio of real-time and historical market data and insights from worldwide sources and experts.

World-Check

Screen for heightened risk individual and entities globally to help uncover hidden risks in business relationships and human networks.

Advertise With Us **Advertising Guidelines** **Purchase Licensing Rights**

All quotes delayed a minimum of 15 minutes. See here for a list of exchanges and delays.

Cookies **Terms & Conditions** **Privacy** **Copyright** **Digital Accessibility** **Corrections** **Data Disclosure and Sources** **Site Feedback** **Manage Cookies**

© 2026 Reuters. All rights reserved